DESIGN & FABRICATION PORTFOLIO

Joshua Stacy

Graphic Design, Illustration & Fabrication

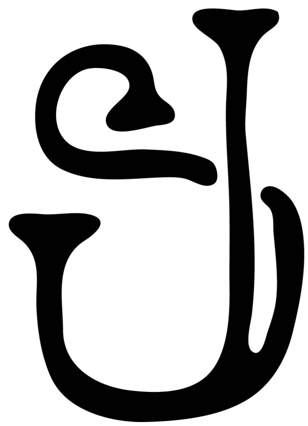
My name is Joshua Stacy and I am a graphic designer, illustrator, and maker in Northwest Arkansas. I am also a professional close-up magician and have been performing for over 2 decades. That background shapes how I approach design: building props and mechanisms by hand for years means solving problems where an idea only counts if the physical object actually executes it, the same standard that applies to a logo, a CAD model, or a cut sign. The following pages cover brand identity and logo work, showing the design process from concept to final mark, along with 3D modeling and fabrication projects that carry that same standard through to a manufactured, working object.

LOGO DESIGN & LETTERING

Joshua Stacy Up Close

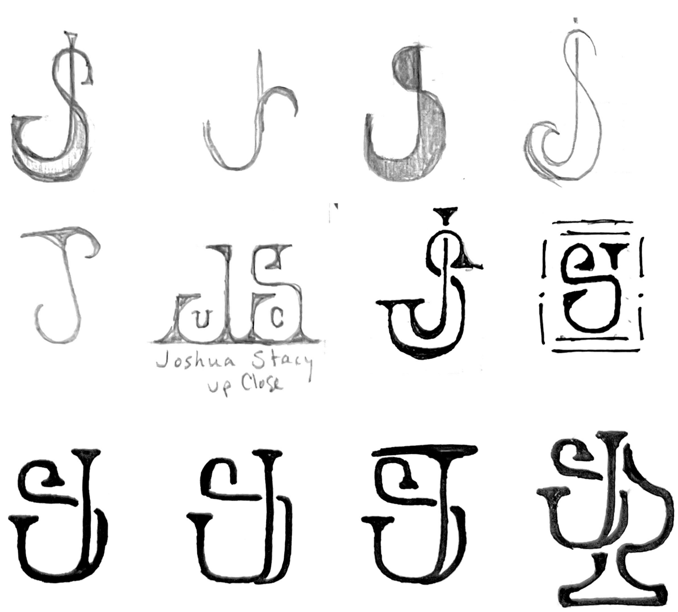
Monogram / Wordmark

As a close-up magician, I wanted a mark that rejected the traditional iconography of the craft: no top hats, wands, or rabbits. Drawing on printer's and maker's marks instead of stage magic tropes, I built a combined JS mark that speaks to the hands-on, self-made nature of the work, since I build most of my own props and routines myself.



Final mark

DEVELOPMENT



MASCOT / EMBLEM DESIGN

Grimtree Wildlife Co.

Embroidered Hat Badge

I designed this as a fictional apparel brand to work in a different visual space than typical outdoor brands like Mossy Oak or Realtree, which lean heavily on camo, deer, and antler imagery. I chose a great horned owl instead, a graceful, silent, and ancient bird of prey, and built the badge as clean embroidered artwork rather than a photography-driven mark, then mocked it up on an actual cap to test how it read as a produced good.

Concept sketch

Finished badge

APPLICATION

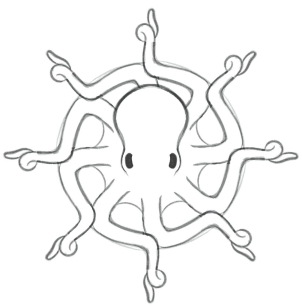
EMBLEM DESIGN

United States Kraken Society

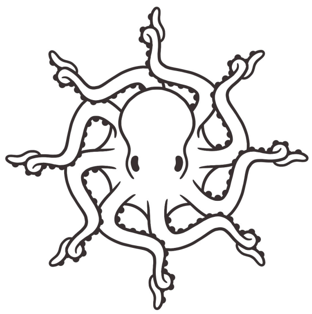
Badge Concept & Iteration

The United States Kraken Society is a fictional citizen-science organization I invented for marine biology and sailing enthusiasts. Rather than illustrate the octopus mascot straightforwardly, I noticed a ship's wheel has eight spokes and an octopus has eight tentacles, the same form in two guises, and built the mark from that overlap rather than from decoration.

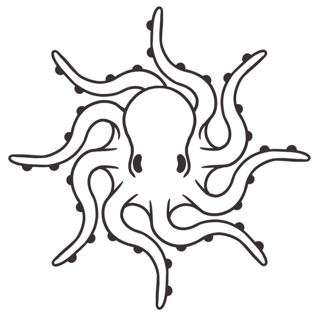
ITERATION



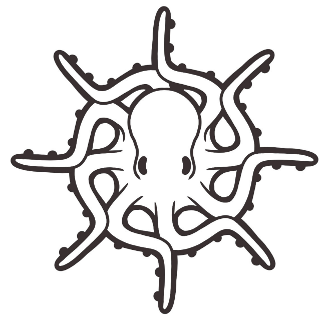
Initial Sketch



Added sucker detail



Experimenting with pose and suckers

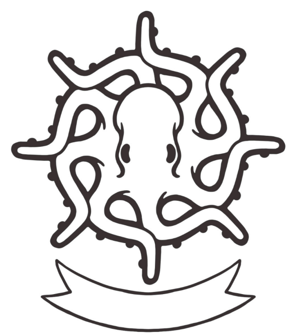


Varying line weight

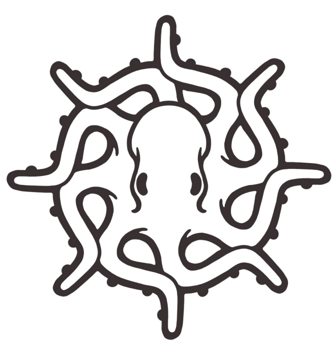
Starting to consider text placement

Further text placement experimentation

Shortening and broadening tentacle tips

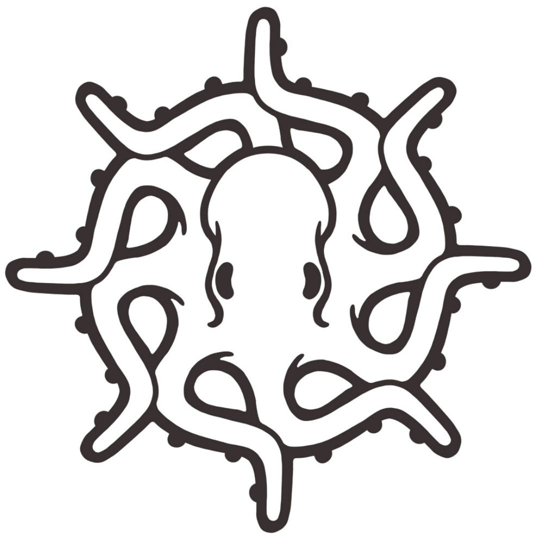


Trying out a banner



Final drawing

UNITED STATES KRAKEN SOCIETY, CONT.



Final line drawing

Finished badge

APPLICATION

SECTION

3D Modeling & Fabrication

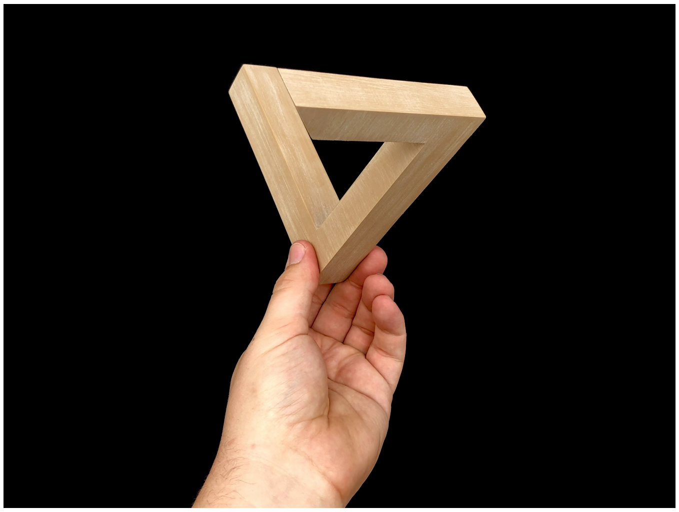
The pieces so far cover branding and logo design. The next section shifts to 3D modeling and fabrication, translating a concept into a physical object that has to hold up under production, not just look right on screen. Each piece went through multiple rounds of printing and testing, adjusting geometry, tolerances, and print orientation, before I settled on a final version. What follows are the finished results of that process.

3D MODELING & PRINTING

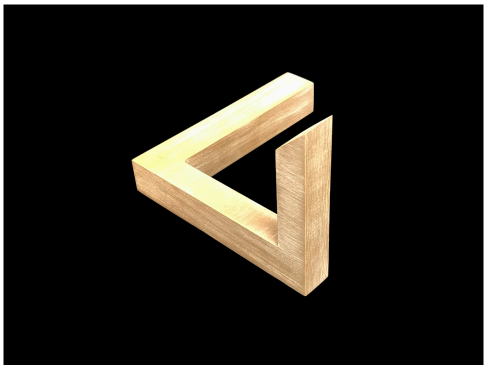
Penrose Triangle

3D-Printed Impossible Object

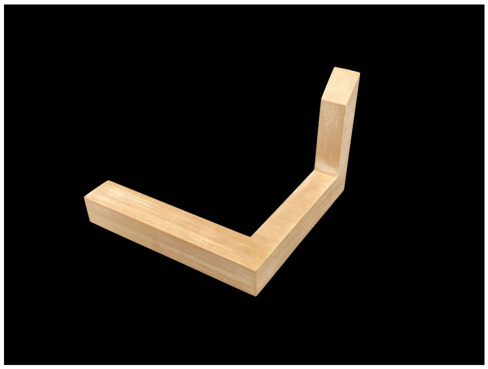
This is a 3D-printed Penrose Triangle, the classic impossible object. The illusion only resolves from one specific viewing angle, so I modeled, printed, and finished it to hold up under a camera lens rather than just on screen. It prints without supports at a 0.2mm layer height, and I hand-sanded the surface in one direction to fake a wood grain finish over a wood-PLA filament blend.



Held to camera, the angle the illusion is designed for



Off-angle view



The actual construction

FULL LISTING & PRINT FILE

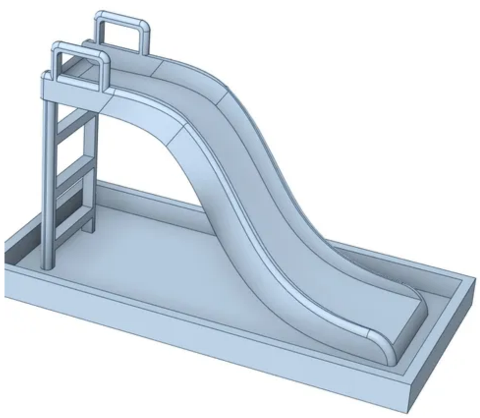
Scan to view the STL file
and print settings on Cults3D

3D MODELING & PRINTING

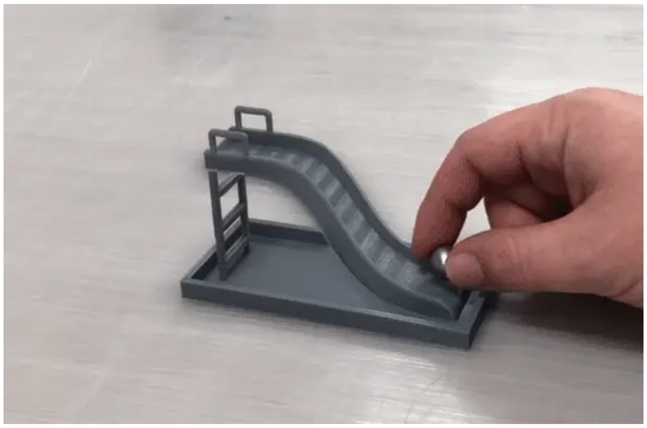
Impossible Slide

Interactive Perspective Illusion

This is a 3D-printed interactive illusion where a ball appears to roll uphill on a playground slide when viewed from the correct angle. Modeled in DesignSpark Mechanical, the hardest part was tuning the curve so it would print cleanly while still reading as convincing from the illusion's specific viewing angle, balancing what the geometry needed to look right against what it needed to actually print without failing.



CAD model



Printed piece, illusion in effect

FULL LISTING & DEMONSTRATION

Scan for STL file & print settings

Scan for video demonstration

3D MODELING & PRINTING

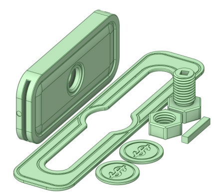
Magic Trick Mechanisms

Coin Thru Bolt / Ball Escape / Christmas Cube

These three magic tricks share the same core challenge: mechanisms that have to work reliably by feel while also reading clean enough to hand to a spectator. The Coin Thru Bolt and the Ball Escape box are both print-in-place designs, meaning the moving parts are modeled with clearances tight enough to print connected and functional straight off the bed. The Christmas Cube's challenge was different: getting the negative-space image cutouts on each face to read clearly, the same problem you'd solve cutting a panel from sheet metal.

Coin Thru Bolt

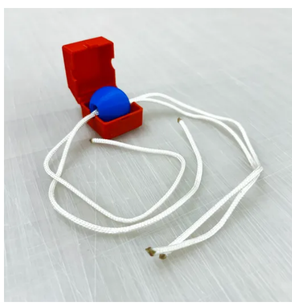
Product photo



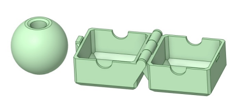
CAD model

Scan for listing

Ball Escape



Product photo

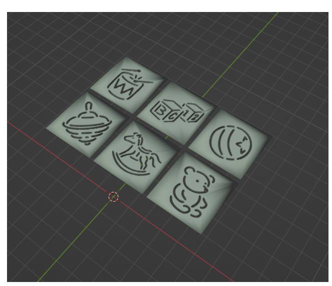


CAD model

Scan for listing

Christmas Cube

Product photo



CAD model

Scan for listing

CLOSING

Thank You

Thank you for reviewing this portfolio. I'd welcome the chance to talk through any of these pieces in more detail, and to discuss how the design, CAD, and production experience shown here could fit L&L Metal Fabrication's work.

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